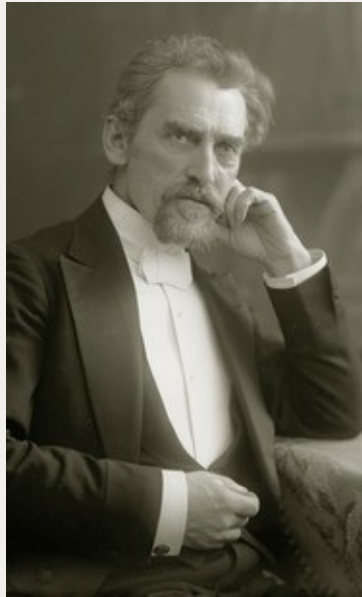


IN PROFILE

Robert Kajanus

Sibelius was fortunate that, unlike many composers, he never had to wait long to hear a new orchestral work for the first time. In 1882, Robert Kajanus (1856–1933) founded the Helsinki Orchestral Society, Finland’s first professional orchestra (today the Helsinki Philharmonic Orchestra). A lifelong friend (and drinking companion), Kajanus often conducted Sibelius’s music, and also made his orchestra available for Sibelius to conduct himself. In the early 1930s, he made the very first commercial recordings of Sibelius’s orchestral music; these are still regarded as unsurpassed classics.



ROBERT KAJANUS

Johan Sibelius (he took the French version of his first name in